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EPISODE 1

1 **INT. PHOTO STUDIO - DAY** 1

Flashes shine throughout the room. **LUCAS** (singer, superstar) is shirtless as water drips down his abs into the waistband of his jeans.

PHOTOGRAPHER
(snapping, shouting)
Perfect! One more!

CREW MEMBER A
With Luca's shoot, the magazine's numbers will blow past a million.

CREW MEMBER B
His last album already hit a million, and now he's booked for the Super Bowl halftime show. Guy's untouchable right now!

2 **INT. DRESSING ROOM - DAY** 2

EMILY (manager, single mom) struggles in, couture in one hand, three iced Americanos in the other, a call sheet wedged under her arm.

ASSISTANT A
(poking her shoulder)
Emily! The Dior suit's wrinkled. I want it pressed in ten minutes!

Emily nods and starts handing things off to the stars.

ASSISTANT B
(throws her a set of keys)
And move the trailer from the garage to the side door.

ASSISTANT C
(shoves towels in her arms)
Floor's covered in hairspray. Mop it while you're at it.

EMILY
(exhausted, nodding)
Got it… got it…

From outside, a **MANAGER** bellows.

MANAGER (O.S.)
Emily! Where the hell are you? Did you print out the contract? Is the inventory list ready?

Emily rushes out of the dressing room.

3 **INT. RECORD LABEL - DAY** 3

Lucas throws on a shirt, buttons only halfway. **DAVID**, the company CEO, hurries up and slaps his shoulder.

DAVID
Lucas! You rejected all seven managers the company assigned you! What are you looking for?

LUCAS
(lazy, unconcerned)
What’s the rush? Haven’t found the right fit.

DAVID
You’re the top star in the country! You need someone to manage your calendar, book events, and clean up your messes!

David tosses down paparazzi photos of Lucas flipping off photographers. Lucas picks one up and admires it.

LUCAS
Isn't he just most handsome man alive? Come on, David, don’t be so mad.

Lucas steps into the elevator and waves.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Relax. I'll tell you by sunset.

4 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY** 4

Emily races down the hall, barely able to see over the stack of files and a gown in her arms.

EMILY
Excuse me! Coming through!

ANNA, arm-in-arm with **MARK**, deliberately knocks into her. Papers scatter everywhere.

ANNA
Well, well. Emily. Look at you now that Mark’s left you.

Emily scrambles to pick up her things. Anna steps closer, heel pinning Emily’s shoe, showing off a diamond necklace.

ANNA (CONT'D)
Mark bought me this. Gorgeous, isn't it? And you can’t even afford your kid's class trip. She must be so disappointed in you.

Emily rises, teeth clenched.

EMILY
You dropped two grand on a necklace, but your daughter has to miss her class trip? Some father you are.

MARK
(shrugging)
Too bad she can't miss out on your loser genes! Don’t forget, you quit your job to be a full-time mom.

EMILY
You begged me to quit teaching to raise our kid. Now I’m the loser?

ANNA
Sweetheart, a failure’s a failure. You gave up your career for him. Now you’re worthless.

EMILY
Shut up. You don’t get to judge me, home wrecker.

Emily raises a hand to slap Anna, but Mark grabs her wrist and slaps her instead. Emily stomps on Anna’s foot and bolts away. Anna and Mark scream curses. Her phone rings. She fumbles to answer.

DAVID (V.O.)
Emily! Three scripts to Lucas’s villa, now. He needs to pick a role in thirty minutes. One second late, I'll dock your whole day’s pay!

EMILY
(rolling her eyes)
Got it. On my way.

5 **EXT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 5 4.

The iron gates swing open. A **BUTLER** leads Emily inside. Emily hurries with the scripts, almost tripping on the uneven stone path.

EMILY
(mutters)
Rich asshole can’t even fix the path…

She reaches the garden. Lucas scrolls his phone. On the phone screen is a DM from the user "OnlyU_Lucas":

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
Lukiepoo, that white suit you wore last week was gorgeous. Next time wear black! It drives me wild.

The sunset glazes the pool gold. Lucas sighs, tosses his phone, and dives in. Emily calls out.

EMILY
Mr. Lucas, I’m here to drop off-

Lucas bursts from the water, slicking his hair back, droplets sliding from his collarbone down his abs. Emily freezes, staring, throat dry.

EMILY (V.O.)
God, his body should be illegal.

Lucas blinks, surprised.

LUCAS
It’s you?

EPISODE 2

6 **EXT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 6

Emily snaps back to reality, clears her throat.

EMILY
Here’s your MV scripts, Mr. Lucas. Please read them.

LUCAS (V.O.)
She really doesn’t remember me.

Lucas frowns, then smirks slightly. He reaches out.

LUCAS
Hand it to me.

Emily hesitates, then offers the script. Lucas grabs her wrist and yanks her into the pool.

EMILY
(struggling)
Help! I can't swim—

Lucas pulls her up, arm locking around her waist. Emily instinctively plants her hand on his chest. Their eyes lock. Lucas glances down at her hand and raises a brow.

LUCAS
Throwing yourself at me? Bold move.

Emily flushes, quickly looks away, shoves at his chest.

EMILY
Sorry. I'm too old for you.

Lucas narrows his eyes, brushing a droplet from the corner of her lips with his thumb.

LUCAS
You say you're not interested, but your heartbeat is so fast!

Emily blushes deeper.

EMILY
Let me go. I've got work to do.

She scrambles out of the pool, clothes dripping, clutching her chest as she rushes off. Lucas watches her retreating figure, memory flooding back.

FLASHBACK STARTS

7 **INT. REHEARSAL ROOM - DAY** 7

Seventeen-year-old Lucas hugs a guitar in the corner. A group of **TEENS** sneer at him.

TEEN A
(shoving the guitar back into his arms, loud)
That's, what, your eighth fail? If all you can do is write songs, go home!

TEEN B
With that small-town accent, you think a big label’s gonna sign you? Go back to your cows, hillbilly.

Lucas clutches the guitar, jaw tight, silent.

EMILY (O.S.)
That’s enough!

The students freeze, turn.

STUDENTS
Miss Emily…

Emily ignores them. She crouches in front of Lucas.

EMILY
They got in because of family connections. You’ll get the role because of hard work. The audience will always remember the ones who really worked for it.

She stands, extending a hand.

EMILY (CONT'D)
Failure doesn’t mean it’s over. You came here to prove you can be better, didn’t you?

She stands in the light, hair haloed in gold. Lucas looks up, slowly reaching up to take her hand.

END FLASHBACK

8 **EXT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 8

LUCAS (V.O.)
Eight years. Her words burned into me. Because of her, I gave everything, and I made it here.

Lucas lowers his gaze.

LUCAS
She still sees me as a kid. That’s fine. As long as I can step back into her world… I’ll take my time.

He swims to the edge, climbs out with ease, grabs his phone from a lounge chair. ON SCREEN: A DM.

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
Lukiepoo, you were in my dreams again last night. I love you so much. Please, just reply once… it's the only reason I can keep going.

Expression flat, Lucas deletes it. He dials David, puts it on speaker while drying his hair with a towel.

LUCAS
(lazily)
I've made my choice. Emily Carter will be my manager. Tell her she starts tomorrow.

DAVID (V.O.)
Fine, it's your call! That crazy fan still sliding in your DMs?

LUCAS
I deleted her DM. What?

DAVID
Lucas! This is serious! I'm ready to call the cops!

LUCAS
(flat, dismissive)
Okay, okay. Next one she sends, I'll forward it to you, alright?

He hangs up mid-conversation and tosses the phone aside. Snapping his fingers, he looks at the approaching butler with a wicked smile.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Go bring Miss Emily back here.

EPISODE 3

9 **EXT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 9

Emily reaches the front gate when the butler rushes up with a towel.

BUTLER
Please, change into something dry. Mr. Lucas still needs to see you.

Emily glances down at her soaked clothes, hesitates, then takes the towel.

EXT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY

Emily, now in one of Lucas's shirts, rolls up the sleeves as she walks. Lucas lounges on a deck chair, robe half-open, abs gleaming in the sunset.

LUCAS
(looking up)
Perfect. I have an offer for you. Be my manager.

EMILY
(no hesitation)
Sorry. I'm not switching clients right now.

She turns to leave.

LUCAS
Five grand a month.

Emily keeps walking.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Plus a year-end bonus. I heard you have a daughter? I'll cover her tuition!

Emily freezes. Hesitation flickers across her face.

FLASHBACK STARTS

11 **INT. EMILY'S APARTMENT - DAY** 11

CHLOE sits at the table, sketching a rocket.

EMILY
(kneeling beside her)
I'm sorry, sweetie. I don't have the money to send you to the observatory trip… Are you mad at me?

Chloe reaches up and pets her mom's head with a smile.

CHLOE
I know 135 bucks is a lot for us. It's okay, Mom. Honestly, I didn't really want to go.

END FLASHBACK

Emily presses a hand to her chest, biting her lip.

EMILY
I—

Her phone rings, cutting her off. She answers.

DAVID
Emily! Lucas requested you, or he walks. If he breaks contract, you’re paying the penalty!

EMILY
(shocked)
Me?! David, you know I-

DAVID
Shut it! Do you know how many people would kill for this job? Eight A.M. tomorrow. Don’t be late!

He hangs up. Emily glares, teeth clenched, then whirls back.

EMILY
Fine. But I want cash daily. No overtime.

LUCAS
(chuckling)
Deal.

Emily signs the papers and hands them over. Lucas scans them, nods, and tosses them aside.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
(grinning, opening his robe)
First task. Right now.
(points at his shoulder)
After-sun lotion. Even it out.

EMILY
(glaring)
You’re serious?

LUCAS
(shrugging)
A manager should handle everything.

Emily exhales, sits beside him, squeezes lotion into her hand, and touches his shoulder.

EMILY (V.O.)
His skin's hotter than I thought. Harder too. Such a perfect body is wasted on such an asshole.

Lucas closes his eyes, his breathing heavier.

EPISODE 4

13 **EXT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 13

Lucas shivers under Emily's touch, barely able to maintain his composure.

LUCAS
Alright… you passed. Be here on time tomorrow.

Lucas opens his eyes, puts on his robe, and leaves, leaving Emily staring, speechless.

14 **MONTAGE STARTS** 14

15 **INT. RECORDING STUDIO - DAY** 15

LUCAS
I want seven iced Americanos, all at two degrees difference each. I need them in the studio in exactly one hour.

EMILY
Planning to open a coffee shop?

LUCAS
Timer starts… now.

Emily exhales sharply and jogs down the hall, teeth clenched. Lucas' smile fades, a touch hurt.

LUCAS (V.O.)
She forgot me… might as well charge a little interest. Fair enough.

16 **INT. VAN - DAY** 16

Lucas gestures for Emily to get in. He slides into the driver's seat, locks the doors, and leans toward her. Emily instinctively crosses her arms, leaning back.

EMILY
Stop. You're my boss, and younger than me! If anyone saw us, it'd look really bad.

Lucas smirks mischievously, tossing 200 posters into her lap and a pen into her hand. Emily groans, and signs them.

LUCAS (V.O.)
Since she thinks I'm too young, I'll be as childish as I want.

17 **INT. COMPANY - DAY** 17

Lucas, in a sharp suit, pauses mid-step, lifts a foot. Emily walks behind him, puzzled. Lucas points to his untied shoelace. Emily crouches, rolling her eyes, tying it for him.

18 **MONTAGE ENDS** 18

19 **INT. COMPANY - DAY** 19

Lucas takes a couple of steps, then stops again.

LUCAS
Wait. Go to ML and pick up my suit. Charity gala starts at seven tonight.

EMILY
ML? That's eighty miles to go there and back. I can't be back by seven.

LUCAS
(raising an eyebrow)
Unless you want to risk breaking your manager contract…

EMILY
(gritting her teeth, on the edge)
Don't push me too far-

Her words cut off as her phone rings. She snatches it up.

SCHOOL TEACHER (V.O.)
Mrs. Carter? Chloe's in trouble. Please come immediately!

Emily's eyes go wide.

20 **INT. TEACHER'S OFFICE - DAY** 20

Emily bursts in. Chloe stands in the corner, her lip scraped, school uniform collar askew.

EMILY
Sweetie, are you okay?

Chloe bursts into tears and clings to her mother.

CHLOE
Mom-

Emily pats her back, face full of worry. **MRS. PETERSON** and her **SON** stands nearby, her arms crossed, shouting.

MRS. PETERSON
Look at my son! Your daughter scratched him up! You need to pay his medical bills, emotional damages, every penny!

MRS. THOMPSON's **SON** is crying too, holding a scraped arm.

MRS. THOMPSON
Fatherless kids are wild! You owe us three grand today, or we're suing you!

Emily wipes Chloe's tears.

EMILY
Chloe, what happened?

CHLOE
(tears streaming)
They said I have no dad, and mom doesn't want me because I couldn't even afford the observatory trip… and I'm a freak. They pushed me first.

Emily glares at the teachers, furious.

EMILY
Did you hear that? My daughter doesn't start fights for no reason. Did you check the cameras?

TEACHER
That was in a blind spot for the cameras. The school doesn’t want a big scandal. Either you pay up, or according to regulations, Chloe will be expelled.

Emily stands, enraged.

EMILY
This isn’t my daughter’s fault!

TEACHER
(impatient)
Mrs. Carter, you know how competitive this school is. Keep fighting, and it’ll hurt you both.

Emily grits her teeth, walks to the door, hesitates, then calls Mark.

EMILY
Chloe’s in trouble. Need three grand. Lend it to me. I’ll pay you back next week.

MARK (V.O.)
Three grand? Listen, you produced a liability, and now you want me to pay? Dream on!

EMILY
(gritting teeth)
She’s still your daughter!

MARK (V.O.)
(laughing)
How about you spend a night with me, and I might give a discount?

Emily slams the phone down, furious.

MRS. PETERSON
Fatherless kids have no manners.

The **PARENTS** laugh. Mrs. Peterson's son blows a raspberry.

YOUNG PETERSON
Freak! Freak! Your mom can’t even afford the observatory! Go count stars at the dump!

Emily kneels beside Chloe, about to speak, when a deep male voice cuts through the room.

LUCAS (O.S.)
Who said my daughter is fatherless?

Everyone looks to the doorway. Lucas stands there, mask on, hat low, one hand in his pocket.

EPISODE 6

21 **INT. TEACHER'S OFFICE - DAY** 21

Lucas walks up to Emily, draping a hand over her shoulder.

LUCAS
Sorry I'm late. My flight was late.

Emily freezes for a moment. Mrs. Peterson eyes Lucas up and down, scoffing.

MRS. PETERSON
Well, who's this?

LUCAS
I'm Chloe's father.
(turns to Emily)
Honey, you okay?

Emily stiffens for a beat, then leans in slightly, whispering, curious.

EMILY
How did you even find me?

LUCAS
(winks)
Let's just say I care about my manager.

Lucas looks down at Chloe, scoops her up, and pulls out the tickets.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Sweetheart, I brought you observatory tickets. Next week, we're counting stars together.

Chloe's tears vanish instantly. She gasps, stunned, then throws her arms around Lucas' neck.

CHLOE
I love you, Dad!

Emily shakes her head, smiling helplessly.

MRS. THOMPSON
(frowning)
You still owe us—

Lucas glares at her.

LUCAS
Fine. First, apologize to my daughter. Then explain who told you to say all those things. Otherwise… you'll soon find out who you're messing with.

EPISODE 7

22 **INT. TEACHER'S OFFICE - DAY** 22

MRS. PETERSON
(laughing)
Threatening me? Dressed so fancy? Bet this is Emily's paid boyfriend. No wonder she rushed to ditch her ex, she's a real cougar, huh?

MRS. THOMPSON
Exactly. Even if you're just trying to trick our kids, at least hire a decent actor! Young man, are you even at drinking age?

MRS. PETERSON
(points at Lucas' shoes)
Limited edition? Definitely fake. Poor peasants can't even afford good knockoffs.

The mothers and kids laugh. Their phones start buzzing.

MR. PETERSON (V.O.)
Our deals with Starry Globe Entertainment are canceled! We're going bankrupt! Who the hell did you piss off?

MR. THOMPSON (V.O.)
Starry Globe pulled out! Our stocks are plummeting! Bank wants the margin now! This is all your fault! We're getting a divorce!

Their faces drain of color. Phones drop.

MRS. PETERSON
(disbelief, looking at Lucas)
Could it be… you…?

The **PRINCIPAL** rushes in, panting, waving at the group.

PRINCIPAL
The school knows the truth. You kids apologize to Chloe immediately!

TEACHER
(shocked)
Principal, the kids were just messing around-

PRINCIPAL
(points at teacher)
You, you're encouraging bullying? You're fired.

The teacher pales as two security guards escort them out. young Peterson and young Thompson, pushed by their moms, reluctantly step forward and bow.

YOUNG PETERSON / YOUNG THOMPSON
We're sorry.

They drag their kids away. The principal turns to Emily, bowing slightly.

PRINCIPAL
Mrs. Carter, the school will strengthen security. Chloe will not suffer again. Otherwise, the entire board will personally apologize.

Emily is stunned.

LUCAS
You better make sure that happens.

Lucas takes Chloe's hand and Emily's, leading them out.

23 **INT. CAR - DAY** 23

Emily leans back in the passenger seat, sighing.

EMILY (V.O.)
Maybe Chloe really does need a dad to protect her.

(glances at Lucas)
He seems so cold on the surface, I didn't expect him of all people to step up for me when it matters.

EMILY
(grateful)
Thanks for today. Really.
(serious)
But next time… please don't intervene. You know how many rumors would start if the press heard about it.

Lucas removes his mask, smiling.

LUCAS
Rumors? Dating, or secretly married with a kid?
(glances at Chloe)
Aren't you the one who treated me like a kid? Scared to be caught in a scandal with a kid?

Emily hesitates, silent, staring out the window.

LUCAS (V.O.)
How can I prove you can rely on me too?

Chloe suddenly leans forward from the back seat, eyes widening as she sees Lucas' face.

CHLOE
Lucas! It's really you!

EPISODE 8

24 **INT. CAR - DAY** 24

CHLOE
(excited)
Mom, it's Lucas! I'm your biggest fan! Can I take a selfie with you?

Lucas deliberately tilts his hat back, flashing his signature smile and winks at her.

LUCAS
Of course. But your mom has to pinky swear to treat me a little better from now on.

Chloe turns to Emily, hands clasped in a pleading gesture.

CHLOE
Mom, please? He was so cool today!

Lucas smirks at Emily, raising an eyebrow. Emily sighs, pulling her hand back reluctantly.

EMILY
Chloe, buckle your seatbelt first…

CHLOE
Mom, please! Just one selfie! I'll skip ice cream for a whole month!

EMILY
Fine…

Lucas immediately reclines the seat, makes space, scoops Chloe onto his lap with one arm, and holds up the phone with the other. Emily is in the frame reluctantly. Lucas looks at the photo, satisfied, and shakes the phone at her.

LUCAS
(mouthing, smug)
Perfect. Post it. People will think we're a real family, right?

Chloe sits, hugging the phone, grinning like an idiot.

EMILY
(to Lucas, scolding)
Shut up!
(to Chloe, calm)
Sweetie, let's head home now.

Chloe nods. Lucas steps on the gas, and they drive off.

25 **INT. BACKSTAGE - EVENT HALL - DAY** 25

Lucas and Emily just walk in when an assistant rushes up with a pink envelope.

ASSISTANT
Lucas, someone at the entrance insisted this be handed to you personally.

The assistant leaves. Emily, holding the schedule, glances at the envelope.

EMILY
Another obsessed fan? I'll go check the stage positions. Don't worry.

LUCAS
Relax.

Lucas opens the envelope. It's another creepy fan letter, pages filled with dense writing. His expression darkens.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
(low, muttering)
Unbelievable…

He rips the letter into pieces, tossing them into the trash.

EMILY (O.S.)
Lucas! You can come over now!

Lucas exhales, pats his face, restores his composure, and heads toward Emily.

26 **INT. EVENT HALL - DAY** 26

Cameras flash, screams erupt. Lucas stands on stage, holding the microphone, calm and practiced.

LUCAS
Thank you all for supporting me.
I'm so happy to see you all here…

His eyes sweep over the front row, locking on a girl in a red dress. Suddenly, he remembers a line in the letter.

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
If you dare look at the girl in red in the front row, I'll gouge her eyes out…

LUCAS (V.O.)
She's here?

Lucas instinctively steps back slightly, trembling. Emily notices immediately and rushes onto the stage.

EMILY
Lucas! Are you-

Lucas steadies himself. Emily trips on a step, stumbling and sliding along the marble floor straight between his legs. The crowd goes silent, then cameras flash again. Emily is frozen, mind blank. In the corner, the **OBSESSED FAN**, wearing a mask and baseball cap glares at them, eyes filled with menace.

27 **INT. EVENT HALL - DAY** 27

Lucas reacts instantly, stepping forward and bending down to help Emily up, his expression calm and composed.

LUCAS
Just a little hiccup there. Let's move on to the next segment, Q&A! Who's got a question?

The crowd erupts, microphones shooting up. The host hurries forward to take control.

HOST
Alright! Let's start with this fan right here!

Applause and screams fill the hall again. Emily, embarrassed, covers her face and scurries off the stage.

28 **INT. OFFICE - DAY** 28

Emily sits at her desk, scrolling through trending topics on her phone: #LucasManagerStageSlip. The comments are full of mockery and memes. Rebecca even sent a string of laughing emojis. Emily buries her face in her hands.

EMILY
Oh my god… This is mortifying… how am I supposed to live with this?

29 **EXT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 29

Lucas lounges with his phone, replaying the video of Emily slipping on stage. A grin spreads across his face.

LUCAS
So smooth even when she trips… how is she this cute?

He screenshots a few frames, editing them into ridiculous memes, and sends them to Emily with a mischievous smile. After sending, he stares at their chat, gradually growing thoughtful.

LUCAS (V.O.)
She saved me again. Was it just because I'm her client, or… does she like me just a little too?

His face lights up with a spark of excitement. He sets the phone aside, jumps into the pool, and swims several laps, carefree. Emily storms up, yelling.

EMILY
Lucas! Delete that meme right now!

No response. Her eyes land on the phone on the table, and she snatches it up. The screen lights up. She freezes. Lucas already set the ridiculous, ugly meme as his screensaver.

EMILY (CONT'D)
(shaking, furious)
You… bastard… what have you done!

Suddenly, the phone rings. Emily frowns at the unknown number, instinctively reaching to answer.

EMILY (CONT'D)
Who could this be?

EPISODE 10

30 **EXT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 30

Water splashes behind her. Emily instinctively turns. Lucas snatches the phone and holds it high.

LUCAS
If you're cringing so much, there's no way I'm deleting it.

EMILY
Delete it! Right now!

She reaches for it but accidentally stumbles forward, landing squarely in Lucas' arms.

LUCAS
(raising an eyebrow)
Seduction tactic?

EMILY
(pushes him away)
Lucas, you're hopeless!

She glares at him, teeth gritted, and spins to walk off.

LUCAS
Thanks. I know you went on stage to help me.

Emily nearly trips, stops, and glances back. Lucas catches up quickly, and they stand face to face. 22.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
(sincerely)
But I wanted to know, was it just professional instinct to protect the artist? Or do you still see me as a kid? Or maybe…

LUCAS (V.O.)
…is there a tiniest chance it's because you have feelings for me?

Lucas leans in, aiming for a kiss. Emily's lashes flutter, her gaze locked on his, then she leans closer, her nose almost brushing his face. Lucas freezes, his Adam's apple bobbing.

LUCAS (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Does she want to kiss me too?

He instinctively closes his eyes, lashes trembling. Emily notices, and her fingertip brushes a piece of glitter stuck near his eye.

EMILY
A bit of glitter on set fell on your face, almost got in your eye!

Lucas opens his eyes, ears pink, expression flustered. He takes a step back, retreating like he's fleeing.

LUCAS
I just remembered… there's something else I need to do.

Emily watches his hurried retreat, suppressing a smile.

EMILY
(softly, to herself)
Did he seriously think I was going to kiss him?

Her phone rings.

REBECCA (V.O.)
Hey babe! I set up a blind date for you, tomorrow at 9! Don't miss it!

Her mind flashes back to Chloe being bullied at school, and Mark's mocking words echo in her head.

EMILY
Maybe Chloe does need a new dad…
Fine, send me the address.

Meanwhile, Lucas, a few steps away, perks up.

LUCAS (V.O.)
A blind date?!

EPISODE 11

31 **INT. RESTAURANT - DAY** 31

Emily is dressed up, seated by the window. She takes out her phone to text her best friend, Rebecca, eyes constantly scanning the restaurant. Lucas, wearing a cap and mask, sits directly behind her. **TOBY** (40) walks in wearing a simple but sharp suit, heading toward Emily's table (table #7).

TOBY
(extending hand, smiling)
Hi, Emily. I'm Toby. It's an honor to meet you.

EMILY
(shaking his hand)
Hello, Toby. Nice to meet you too.

They sit. The mood is light and conversational.

TOBY
You're a talent manager, right? I hear you work with a lot of celebrities. Must be interesting.

EMILY
Yes, it's fulfilling, and I love what I do. Do you like kids?

TOBY
Of course! I've always wanted a daughter! She must be adorable.

EMILY
(relieved)
Chloe is a really sweet kid.

Lucas leans back in his chair, tapping his fingers on his knee, his expression darkening. Toby gets up.

TOBY
Excuse me, I need to wash my hands.

He walks away. Emily watches him leave. As soon as he's gone, 24. Lucas rises and leans in close, voice low and dangerous.

LUCAS
How can you chat with him so easily? Do you even know what kind of man he is?

EMILY
(surprised)
Why are you here? I'm just your manager, this isn't your business.

LUCAS
(gets up, teeth gritted)
Fine. I'm leaving.

Lucas opens the door, and catches Toby there on his phone.

TOBY
(mocking)
Mom, don't worry! She's forty and in showbiz, she definitely has money. Once I win her over, the house goes in my name, then I'll dump her.

Lucas' eyes turn icy. He spins on his heel and strides back inside. Toby pushes the door open, smiling, but Lucas is already in front of Emily.

EMILY
You again-

Without hesitation, Lucas cups the back of her neck and kisses her on the lips.

EPISODE 12

32 **INT. RESTAURANT - DAY** 32

Emily's eyes widen in shock. She yanks back and slaps Lucas.

EMILY
(angry)
Are you crazy?! Who gave you the right to do that?!

Lucas freezes, stunned. Toby rushes forward.

TOBY
You have a boyfriend and still came to a blind date? The fuck?

I just wanted to snag an ATM, and surprise, it belongs to someone!

Emily's face instantly hardens.

EMILY
So you were just here to make a quick buck.

TOBY
What else? You're almost forty, divorced, and dragging a kid along. You think I actually care?

Lucas' anger flares. He grabs Toby by the collar, eyes cold and lethal.

LUCAS
Say one more word insulting her, and I'll make sure you can't set foot in Los Angeles.

Toby scoffs at first, then looks up, finally registering Lucas' face. His eyes widen in shock, then gleam with mischievous amusement.

TOBY
You… you are-

Emily snaps back to reality and pulls Lucas away.

EMILY
You're right. I am almost forty. But I know myself better than I did at twenty. At least I don't need to put others down to feel superior.

She notices whispers around them and quickly grabs Lucas' cap, plopping it on his head. She grabs his arm and pulls him out of the restaurant. In the corner, a masked woman snaps pictures, teeth clenched.

OBSESSED FAN
(through gritted teeth)
Bitch! How dare you touch my man! You'll pay for this!

EPISODE 13

33 **INT. CAR - DAY** 33

Emily glances at Lucas' cheek, still marked red from her slap. She instinctively reaches out, then hesitates.

EMILY
(soft, remorseful)
I… I'm sorry. Let me put some ointment on it.

Panicking, she looks around for supplies. Lucas retrieves a first-aid kit from the back seat and hands it to her.

LUCAS
(coldly)
Think this will make me forgive you? No chance.

He leans closer as she applies ointment to his cheek.

EMILY
I already told you, if you were photographed just now, you'd be on the front page tomorrow!

LUCAS
(nonchalant)
I don't care. But didn't you learn from your past? Rushing into a relationship again?

EMILY
(sighs)
It's for Chloe. You saw what happened at school. I can live without a husband, but Chloe needs a father.

LUCAS
If you insist on finding someone for your daughter… The dating market is basically a mess right now. Why not… consider me?

EMILY
(laughing, incredulous)
Lucas?! Are you insane?! You?!

LUCAS
I don't see the problem. Chloe seems to like me too.

EMILY
(amused, exasperated)
That's… completely different!

Emily moves to get out of the car. Lucas grabs her hand and gently pins her back into the passenger seat.

34 **INT. CAR - DAY** 34

Lucas' phone suddenly rings. Emily glances at his screen. Lucas frowns, mutters under his breath, and releases Emily.

LUCAS
Damn it-

He reluctantly answers.

DAVID (V.O.)
Lucas, get over here now! There's a problem with the collab single!

He hangs up. Emily puts her seatbelt on and looks at a text.

EMILY
You go to the meeting. I need to stop by the office to grab a package. No idea who sent it.

LUCAS
(alert)
A package? I'm coming with you.

Before Emily can object, Lucas guns the engine and heads for the office.

35 **INT. COMPANY - OFFICE - DAY** 35

A brown paper box sits at Emily's desk. She lifts it and starts to peel the tape. From the corner of his eye, Lucas sees the sender name: ONLYU. His face goes cold. He slams his hand down on the box.

LUCAS
Did you print the MV script for the collab? Fifteen copies for the meeting.

EMILY
(skeptical)
Fifteen? Who needs that many? You better not be messing with me.

She sets the box down and heads for the copy room. The moment she's out of sight, Lucas snatches up the box and slips into the empty break room.

Lucas rips open a drawer, pulls on latex gloves, and tears through the tape. Inside is a torn doll, its chest smeared with red marker like blood. A folded note lies on top, the page is scrawled in red ink. Lucas unfolds it; the words are crude and hateful.

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
DIE, OLD HAG! TOUCH HIM AGAIN AND NEXT TIME IT WON'T JUST BE A DOLL, IT'LL BE YOU!

EPISODE 15

37 **INT. COMPANY - BREAK ROOM - DAY** 37

Lucas' Adam's apple moves rapidly. His face is pale. He carefully repackages the note and the doll, then pulls out his phone to call security.

LUCAS
Check the security footage. Did anyone suspicious enter or leave?

After hanging up, he stuffs the box into the bottom drawer of the filing cabinet and locks it.

38 **INT. COMPANY - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY** 38

Lucas sits on one side of the table, David by his side. Across from them sit the client representative, Mark, and a sharply dressed lawyer, **RYAN.**

MARK
Lucas, we arranged you a publicity relationship to get you trending and promote this collab.

LUCAS
(frowning)
A showmance? We agreed before signing that this was purely a musical collaboration. Why change things last minute?

MARK
(glances at him)
The audience craves gossip. A relationship will definitely blow up the internet.

LUCAS
Sorry, I work for my music, not for clout.

DAVID
(slams the table)
You're crossing a line!

MARK
Clause 16 in the contract is crystal clear! The client gets the final say. Unless you're willing to pay an astronomical penalty for a contract breach.

He gestures to the side.

MARK (CONT'D)
This is our legal counsel, Ryan Grayson.

RYAN
Yes, the contract includes this clause. If Lucas refuses to comply, it could indeed be considered a breach.

Lucas' face darkens. His fists clench tightly.

MARK
Lucas, what's wrong? Can't even act to save your life?

Just then, the door bursts open. Emily storms in, clutching a stack of documents.

EMILY
We cannot agree to this.

Everyone is startled.

EPISODE 16

39 **INT. COMPANY - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY** 39

MARK
(impatient)
You? What happened to your company security? Can anyone just walk in as they please?

EMILY
I’m Lucas’ manager, of course I can come in.

She walks to the table, spreads out the contract, and points to a small footnote.

EMILY (CONT'D)
You keep saying “the client has the final say,” but you ignored this line, “provided it does not damage the actor’s reputation or public image. ” Manufacturing fake relationships already breaches the contract.

Mark’s face stiffens.

MARK
Nonsense! If we don’t do the PR relationship, Anna won’t sing! Cancel the collaboration!

EMILY
Of course you can cancel. But don’t forget, Clause 7 gives the actor the right to terminate if the client makes improper demands, and the client must pay double the breach penalty.

MARK
(slams table, yelling)
Who do you think you are?! Go home and take care of your kid!

Lucas stands up and walks to Emily’s side. He opens his mouth to speak, but Ryan jumps in first.

RYAN
She’s correct. As the lawyer, I must point out that the client’s demands indeed constitute a potential breach.

Mark glares at him.

MARK
Ryan! Who do you work for?

RYAN
I work for the law, not for you.

Everyone in the room stiffens. Mark's face turns dark. He slams the contract down heavily. He storms out. David pats Emily's shoulder, smiling and acknowledging. David leaves. Lucas can't help but smile, his eyes warmly fixed on Emily.

LUCAS (V.O.)
Just like before, no matter what happens, you always stand firmly by my side.

Lucas notices Emily exchanging a smile with Ryan.

LUCAS
They… know each other?

EPISODE 17

40 **INT. COMPANY - DAY** 40

RYAN
I just returned from Boston. It's been a year since we last saw each other, right?

EMILY
Yeah. I heard you're switching to international law? That's great!

RYAN
Thanks.

They walk side by side from the conference room to the break room. Emily occasionally glances at Ryan and smiles. Down the hallway, Lucas sneaks behind them, peeking around corners, eyes fixed on the pair.

LUCAS
Smiling so happily? With him? No way! I need to get her attention!

Unable to stand it, Lucas suddenly steps forward, inserting himself between them.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
(acting casual)
Hey, Ryan, thanks for helping me earlier.

RYAN
No problem.

EMILY
Lucas, what are you doing here?

LUCAS
I’m here to thank Ryan.
(looks at Ryan, smiling)
If it weren’t for you earlier, I almost, well, almost had to fake a romance with that woman. You two know each other?

RYAN
We’re college classmates.

Lucas feigns surprise and casually drapes an arm around Emily’s shoulder.

LUCAS
What a coincidence.

EMILY
(frowning, pushes him)
Hey! Don’t get so close-

Lucas raises his phone.

LUCAS
Smile! Ryan’s here too! Come on, let's take a selfie together!

At that moment, the phone screen lights up. It's an unknown number. Lucas’ smile freezes. He swipes, rejects the call, and pockets the phone smoothly. Emily notices and frowns.

EMILY
How many missed calls is that? Why have you been ignoring so many calls lately?

EPISODE 18

41 **INT. COMPANY - DAY** 41

LUCAS
It’s just scammers, they call me ten times a day!

Ryan, standing nearby, clears his throat softly.

RYAN
(smiling)
Lucas, I’ve listened to your work too. Very talented.

LUCAS
(polite smile)
Thank you, but I don’t understand law, so I can’t comment on you.

RYAN
Good, let's stick to our own lanes.

LUCAS
(smirk, half joking)
No wonder she made you her friend. You really have a way with words.

EMILY
(warning)
Lucas!

LUCAS
Okay, I’ll zip it. Carry on.

Ryan thoughtfully helps Emily take her bag.

RYAN
Let me send you home.

LUCAS
(hastily intervening)
You're a busy lawyer, let me do it.

Emily rolls her eyes at the two men vying to help her. Just as she’s about to speak, Rebecca calls her.

EMILY
Rebecca? Now? But I still need to pick up Chloe…

REBECCA (V.O.)
Girl, you wanted a reliable dad for your daughter, right? A fortune teller told me your true love is a man with a black mole on his Adonis belt! Check if someone around you has it!

EMILY
(laughing)
How would I even see a mole on a guy’s abs? Anyway, I’ve got work to do, gotta go.

Before she can hang up, Lucas snatches Emily’s bag from Ryan.

LUCAS
Sorry, but I'm her knight in shining armor.

He pushes Emily toward the door, glancing back at Ryan with a provoking eyebrow raise.

42 **EXT. EMILY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT** 42

Lucas brings Emily and Chloe home. Chloe clings to Lucas reluctantly.

CHLOE
Come inside and have some water before you go.

EMILY
It's late. Lucas needs to rest.

Lucas glances at Emily, understanding, and finally leaves. Shortly after Emily and Chloe enter, there's a knock at the door. Chloe thinks it's Lucas, but when the door opens, it's Mark. He grabs her, dragging her away. Chloe struggles as Emily chases after them.

EMILY (CONT'D)
(fuming, to Mark)
Are you insane?! Mark, I have sole custody! You need my permission to see her!

MARK
Who do you think you are?

Emily shields Chloe in her arms, glaring at Mark.

EMILY
What do you want?

MARK
Simple. Convince Lucas to fake a romance with Anna.

EMILY
You're dreaming.

MARK
(stepping closer)
Then I guess I'll start picking Chloe up from school every day.

LUCAS (V.O.)
You really think you can do that?

43 **EXT. EMILY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT** 43

Emily shakes her head in disapproval, about to speak, but Lucas, having returned, stops her. He takes Emily's hand, shielding her and Chloe behind him.

MARK
Oh, I see now. How did trash like you become a top star's agent? Turns out you're just finding Chloe a new daddy. Even a top star wants my secondhand goods?

LUCAS
Some people don't deserve pearls, they trample over them like swine. You can't see Emily's worth. Touch them again, and I'll make sure you're banished from the entertainment industry for good.

Mark, stunned, jabs his finger at Lucas' face.

MARK
Cocky brat! Think you'll stay on top forever?

LUCAS
Maybe I won't be on top forever. But your career's already at its end.

Lucas shakes his phone. At that moment, Mark receives a call from his secretary. His face twists with rage before he stomps off. Lucas kneels down, looking at Chloe gently.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
You okay, little one?

CHLOE
I don't want to go with them. I only want mom.

LUCAS
Don't worry. As long as I'm here, no one will hurt you.

EMILY
I'm grateful, but you can't protect us forever.

LUCAS
Why not? I'm not joking. If we get married and I become Chloe's father, then I can, right?

EMILY
Lucas! Do you even know what you're saying?

LUCAS
I'm proposing to you. I'm serious, the timing is a bit bad but- mmph-

Emily covers his mouth.

EMILY
You're insane! It's late, go home already!

Emily pulls Chloe away. Chloe glances back at Lucas, who smiles and winks at her.

EPISODE 20

44 **INT. EMILY'S APARTMENT - EMILY'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 44

In the dark, Emily tosses and turns, eyes wide open.

EMILY
(mutters to herself)
Crazy… he's crazy. Am I crazy too? He's a superstar in his twenties, every girl's dream man. And he wants to marry me and be Chloe's stepdad? This has to be another one of his pranks.

She groans and yanks the blanket over her face.

45 **INT. COMPANY - OFFICE - DAY** 45

Emily, with dark circles under her eyes, shuffles to her desk. She types distractedly, working on a headline ON SCREEN: Lucas, the Future Super S—

SUPERVISOR (O.S.)
Emily, can you come here a sec?

Startled, Emily stands, accidentally hits "SEND," and walks out. All around the office, screens light up with the headline: "Lucas, the Future Super Sissy." Everyone stares, eyes wide. Emily returns, confused at the looks.

COWORKER A
Oh my god… Emily, what did you just post?! The whole internet is asking if he's a bottom, people already made memes!

Emily panics, rushing back to her desk. Her hands tremble as she tries to retract the article.

EMILY (V.O.)
I'm done for… I'm so dead.

46 **EXT. COMPANY - DAY** 46

A flashy sports car screeches to a stop. Lucas opens the door, rips off his sunglasses, and storms inside in fury.

LUCAS
Whoever did this is dead meat!

47 **INT. COMPANY - HALLWAY - DAY** 47

Lucas barrels into the office. Emily, about to return to her desk, freezes. She tries to slip away, glancing back nervously. A big hand clamps around her wrist and yanks her against the wall.

EMILY
(stammering)
Lucas?! I didn't mean to! It was just a typo!

LUCAS
A typo? So it was you?

Lucas's anger is gone instantly. He lets go. Emily rubs her wrist, embarrassed, taking a step back.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
You called me "Super Sissy"?

Emily blushes, waving her hands frantically.

EMILY
No… that's not what I meant!

Suddenly Lucas steps back, unzipping his jacket, fingers going to his shirt buttons.

LUCAS
Alright then. Let me show you right now whether I'm a "sissy" or not.

EMILY
(shocked)
You're insane! This is the office!

Lucas whips off his shirt, revealing his chiseled chest and abs. Emily instinctively covers her face, flustered.

EPISODE 21

48 **INT. COMPANY - HALLWAY - DAY** 48

The camera opens on the dark mole at the top of Lucas's Adonis belt. Emily glances up and freezes as she unintentionally notices the mole.

REBECCA (V.O.)
A fortune teller told me your true love is a man with a black mole on his Adonis belt!

EMILY (V.O.)
That mole… could he really be my soulmate? No! Why am I even daydreaming right now?

EMILY
(covering her face)
I promise I'll handle this!

Lucas looks up, locking eyes on her.

LUCAS
What about emotional damages? How are you going to compensate me?

Emily hesitates, then, almost without thinking, nods.

EMILY
Tell me. I'll try to make it happen, whatever you want.
(remembering)
Except that! No way I'm making you Chloe's dad.

Lucas steps closer, lowering his voice.

LUCAS
Anything but that?

Emily panics and takes a step back, bumping against the edge of a desk.

EMILY
Don’t be silly!

Lucas props himself against the desk beside her, his gaze sliding down to her lips. Their faces inch closer. Emily instinctively closes her eyes. Lucas brushes a speck of dust from her hair, then pulls back and teases with a grin.

LUCAS
You didn’t really think I wanted to kiss you, did you?

EMILY
(opens her eyes, mortified)
WHAT?

LUCAS
Since you’re being so sincere, I’ll give you a chance. My water heater burst. Can you come fix it tonight?

He turns, handsome and playful.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Oh! And bring Chloe too. You can stop me from being her dad, but you can’t stop the kid from liking me!

He winks and starts to walk away.

EMILY
(waiting, stunned)
Hold on!

Lucas looks back over his shoulder, batting his eyes.

LUCAS
See you tonight.

49 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - NIGHT** 49

Lucas sits at his desk, scrolling through emails. There is an email with an attached video. He opens it. The first frame is an edited photo of Lucas kissing Emily. Emily's side is scrawled in red with a big X on her face. It's set against a sickly sweet fan audio:

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
Lukiepoo, don’t you remember me? Why did you let her touch you? You belong to me! If you keep seeing her, I’ll kill her!

The next frame is a grotesque AI image of Emily collapsed in a pool of blood. The video's soundtrack has gunfire and explosions. Lucas's face drains of color. Suddenly, a noise is heard inside the house. Lucas whips his head around, eyes wide, stunned.

EPISODE 22

50 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - NIGHT** 50

Lucas's pupils contract sharply as he frantically deletes the email, his hand trembling.

LUCAS
(under his breath)
Psycho!

He snaps the laptop shut, exhales, then moves quickly toward the sound of the explosion, only to find the kitchen pipe really has burst. A spray of water soaks him from head to toe. The doorbell rings.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Damn! I just wanted to trick her into coming. Now it's actually broken.

He scrambles to block the leak with a towel. Emily, after ringing the bell several times, is about to take Chloe and leave when Lucas finally opens the door. He's soaked.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Don't just stand there, help me!

He grabs Emily by the wrist and pulls her into the kitchen. Together they press their hands over the cracked pipe; water splashes over both of them. Emily staggers and falls right into Lucas's arms. They both freeze. Just then, Chloe bursts into the kitchen.

CHLOE
(smiling knowingly)
What are you two doing?

Emily and Lucas instantly spring apart. Emily brushes the water off her clothes, realizing her neckline is slightly exposed. She glances at Lucas, his shirt clings to him even more revealingly, her cheeks flush red.

EMILY
We should go.

LUCAS
(defiant)
Not until this is fixed. You owe me. Someone called me a "Super Sissy" in the headlines.

EMILY
You’re impossible…

CHLOE
Mom, are we going to stay here? Yay! It’s so pretty here!

She throws herself into Lucas’s arms. He catches her easily, turning to Emily with a smug look.

LUCAS
See? Chloe likes it here.

Emily sighs, helpless. Lucas sets Chloe down on the sofa and sits beside her. The two start chatting excitedly.

CHLOE
Your song’s gone viral! I’ve seen so much news about you online. Is it fun being a singer?

LUCAS
Of course. Here, listen.

He hands Chloe his phone to play a new demo. Emily's POV: Lucas and Chloe are chatting about something. Chloe nods enthusiastically, eyes shining. It's a sweet sight. Emily watches them, her expression complicated.

EMILY (V.O.)
Maybe… maybe Lucas could actually be a good dad…

Lucas turns just in time to catch her gaze. Emily quickly looks away.

EMILY (V.O.) (CONT'D)
This is crazy. How did he rope me into his train of thought?

EPISODE 23

51 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - NIGHT** 51

EMILY
Good night.

Emily closes Chloe's bedroom door, she turns and sees Lucas lying flat on the sofa, eyes closed, pretending to be obedient.

EMILY (CONT'D)
He gave the room to us, but sleeps on the sofa himself.

Emily leaves. Lucas, however, can't help but open his eyes and smile foolishly. A new email arrives on his phone. He sighs heavily.

LUCAS (V.O.)
No. Before I resolve this, I need to make sure they're safe.

52 **EXT. PARKING LOT - DAY** 52

Emily and Ryan walk side by side. Ryan reaches to hold her hand, but a flashy sports car pulls up in front of them, interrupting him. Lucas, in the driver's seat, snaps his fingers. The rear window slowly rolls down, and Chloe leans out, waving happily at Emily.

CHLOE
Mom! Let's go to lunch together!

EMILY
(surprised)
You're back? Aren't you supposed to be at school?

Lucas rests an arm on the car window, holding a phone. He's on Facetime with Chloe. He taps the car body casually but deliberately, eyeing Emily and Ryan, provoking.

LUCAS
(meaningful)
It's the school anniversary today! Chloe gets half a day off. Hop in. Let's go pick up Chloe to lunch.
(fake smile, to Ryan)
As for the big-shot lawyer… he shouldn't intrude on our little family lunch, right?

Emily rolls her eyes.

FLASHBACK STARTS

Lucas drives Emily home.

LUCAS
Don't come to my place with Chloe the next few weeks, I’m a bit busy.

Emily looks at him in surprise.

EMILY (V.O.)
I should have expected this! How could a top idol actually fall for a forty-year-old like me?

END FLASHBACK

54 **EXT. PARKING LOT - DAY** 54

Chloe excitedly speaks up from the phone.

CHLOE
(ON THE PHONE, excited)
Uncle Ryan! Long time no see! I missed you so much!

Ryan bends down with a smile, waving at the phone with a smile.

RYAN
I missed you too, Chloe.

CHLOE
(on the phone)
Mom, why don’t we bring Uncle Ryan along too?

Lucas’s expression darkens instantly. Emily struggles to suppress a laugh and sits in the passenger seat.

EMILY
Of course.

RYAN
Thanks for the invitation.

Lucas grips the steering wheel, cursing under his breath.

55 **INT. HIGH-END RESTAURANT - PRIVATE ROOM - DAY** 55

Lucas is fully covered, a hat and mask hiding him thoroughly. He grabs the menu first, pointing to the dishes to a **WAITER.**

LUCAS
Hmm… I'll have the chili...
(showing Emily the menu)
Emily, what would you like? This restaurant has the best Cajun crawfish boil, you wanna try?

RYAN
(calmly)
Emily doesn’t eat spicy food.

Lucas freezes, switching his recommendation.

LUCAS
How about the PB & J bagel bites?

RYAN
Emily’s allergic to peanuts.

Emily coughs lightly, not looking at Lucas. Lucas grits his teeth, restraining himself, taking a deep breath.

LUCAS
What about the seafood platter?

RYAN
Emily doesn’t like crab.

Chloe can’t help but turn her face away, shoulders shaking slightly as she tries to stifle her laughter. Lucas clenches his fists, slams the menu shut, and stands up abruptly, startling everyone.

EPISODE 25

56 **INT. HIGH-END RESTAURANT - PRIVATE ROOM - NIGHT** 56

Lucas suddenly hands the menu to Ryan, smiling.

LUCAS
I guess I'll just order for myself then. I'll let you do the honors of ordering for us, Ryan.

Lucas grabs the lemonade on the table, pours two glasses, and hands one to Emily. Ryan stays composed, takes the menu, and orders several family sized dishes for the table.

RYAN
These are all things Emily likes.

LUCAS
Ryan, you really know how to take care of people! I guess I have a lot to learn from you!

At this moment, Chloe speaks up excitedly.

CHLOE
Uncle Ryan! I haven't seen you in so long! Did you come back this time just to see Mom?

RYAN
Honestly, I did want to see her, but I also missed you, Chloe.

LUCAS
(interjecting)
Wow, sounds like you don't get much work done. Don't you work a lot?

RYAN
It's okay. My schedule is flexible, unlike a top star.
(to Emily)
Chloe can always come to me if she needs anything.

LUCAS
Is that so? Then why haven't I seen you when Chloe got in trouble?

RYAN
Maybe I'm different from a certain someone. I respect Emily's personal boundaries and wouldn't just show up uninvited.

The two lock eyes, tension rising. Chloe observes, looking between them, seemingly understanding something. Emily tries to stop them from escalating, but the waiter pushes in their dishes. She freezes upon seeing Lucas.

WAITER
(whispering in shock)
Oh my… it's Lucas!

The waiter takes out a phone to take a photo, the flash illuminating the room. Lucas instantly pales, and he reflexively grabs the waiter's arm. When he realizes the waiter is just a cute young girl, he exhales and lets go apologetically. Emily, startled by the commotion, looks at him.

EMILY
(softly)
Hey… what happened?

LUCAS
Sorry, mistook her for someone else.

WAITER
(blushing)
It’s fine, it’s fine.

She hurriedly sets down the tray and quickly leaves.

EMILY (V.O.)
(frowning)
Why did he react so strongly?

EPISODE 26

57 **INT. EMILY’S APARTMENT - NIGHT** 57

Emily enters the apartment with Chloe, carrying a glass of water, about to take a sip. Chloe suddenly stops and looks at her seriously.

CHLOE
Mom, if you had to choose between Uncle Ryan and Uncle Lucas… who would you pick?

Emily chokes on the water, coughing in surprise.

CHLOE (CONT'D)
(with meaning)
If it’s about choosing a dad, I’d pick Uncle Lucas! Superstar dad!

Emily freezes, instinctively trying to deny.

EMILY
Chloe, don't tell anyone that. Lucas and I… it’s impossible. You know I’m eleven years older than him! And he’s a top star, and I…

Chloe tilts her head, then smiles knowingly.

CHLOE
But just now, I only mentioned Lucas once, and you talked so much about him. Looks like… your heart already has the answer.

Emily is stunned, speechless. Chloe stands, shrugging.

CHLOE (CONT'D)
Good night.

She turns and walks straight back to her room.

58 **INT. EMILY'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 58

Emily tosses and turns, unable to sleep. Her phone lights up, and she picks it up. A message from Ryan:

RYAN (V.O.)
Let's hang out together some other time, just the two of us.

Emily stares at the message, her finger pausing. On impulse, she opens Lucas's chat. Chloe's words echo in her mind.

CHLOE (V.O.)
Looks like… your heart already has the answer.

Emily exhales sharply. Just as she's about to lock the screen, Lucas's message pops up.

LUCAS (V.O.)
Good night. See you tomorrow.

Emily freezes for a moment, then a small smile appears. She turns off the phone and curls up under the covers.

59 **INT. FILM SET - DAY** 59

Emily arrives on set just as Lucas is filming a kissing scene. The actress, **SOPHIE** blushes as she leans toward Lucas.

DIRECTOR
Action!

Sophie and Lucas kiss.

SOPHIE
(nervous)
I… Sorry, I forgot my line again.

Second take, they kiss again. Sophie blushes and steps back.

SOPHIE (CONT'D)
Sorry, I'm too nervous.

Third take.

SOPHIE (CONT'D)
Sorry, the lines are too tricky…

Sophie glances at Lucas cautiously, her admiration clear. Lucas struggles to remain patient, taking a deep breath. Emily stands by the monitor, arms crossed, quietly muttering. Fourth take. Lucas snaps, wiping the lipstick from his lips, speaking coldly.

LUCAS
You're not impressing anyone! Don’t waste everyone’s time!

The set falls silent. Sophie lowers her head, almost in tears. Emily steps forward, silently handing him his jacket. He takes it and leans down, smiling slightly.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Jealousy isn't your look, Emily.

EPISODE 27

60 **INT. FILM SET - DAY** 60

EMILY
(nervously)
Me? No, not at all.

LUCAS
(tilting his head)
Still saying no? Then why were you glaring at Sophie just now?

EMILY
I was just checking the time. She did four takes! Can’t afford to waste the budget.

Lucas steps closer, Emily’s back pressed against the wall.

LUCAS
I didn’t even notice. Why are you so anxious?

EMILY
(pushes him, flustered)
I… I’ll go get you some throat lozenges.

Emily spins and rushes off. Lucas puts his hands in his pockets, unable to hide a grin.

Emily returns to the set. It's a state of chaos. Staff are running around in a panic.

EMILY
(hurrying over)
What happened? Is everything okay?

DIRECTOR
(frantic)
Sophie suddenly disappeared! Her phone is off, there's no sign of her anywhere!

Emily frowns, about to speak. Lucas, now in his costume, shirt collar unbuttoned, steps out with an impatient expression.

LUCAS
Did you find her? We need to start filming immediately.

The staff shake their heads silently, too scared to respond. Lucas's gaze shifts to Emily. She freezes, instinctively stepping back.

EMILY
What are you looking at me for?

Lucas raises an eyebrow and points at her.

LUCAS
You. Come here.

EPISODE 28

62 **INT. FILM SET - DAY** 62

All eyes snap to Emily.

EMILY
(waving frantically)
I-I can't! I've never acted in an ad before!

Lucas steps closer, voice calm and confident.

LUCAS
You worked as an acting teacher. A thirty-second ad is super easy!

EMILY
(stunned)
H-how did you know that?

The makeup artist and costume designer exchange a glance.

DIRECTOR
It’s rare to get a nod from Lucas!
Don’t miss this chance!

Before Emily can ask anything, the PA teams each grab one side of her and escort her away. Lucas waits anxiously. Lights go up. Emily emerges slowly in a stunning gown, and everyone freezes.

DIRECTOR (CONT'D)
(applauding)
Absolutely breathtaking! PERFECT!
LET'S ROLL!

Lucas watches her, lips curling into a slight smile, eyes burning with intensity.

LUCAS
(softly, in her ear)
Don’t be afraid. Just look at me.
Like there's only the two of us.

DIRECTOR
Action!

Watching the monitor, he can’t help but nod repeatedly. For the final shot, Lucas leans in slowly, his lips just an inch from Emily’s. They almost kiss.

DIRECTOR (CONT'D)
Cut! Perfect!

Applause breaks out. Emily’s face flushes bright red. She bows her head quickly.

EMILY
(soft, flustered)
Oh my… I… it’s been so long…

Lucas looks at her seriously.

LUCAS
Still doubting yourself? Emily, you shine brighter than anyone. You’re not meant to be someone else’s shadow. You were meant to be in the center of the stage.

Emily stares at him, her eyes full of stirred emotions. 51.

EPISODE 29

63 **INT. FILM SET - DAY** 63

Emily lowers her head, remembering what Lucas said.

EMILY (V.O.)
Lucas is more mature than I imagined. He can even guide me into character.

Just then, the makeup artist hurries over, breaking her train of thought.

MAKEUP ARTIST
Emily, Lucas wants you to bring the outfit over.

Emily snaps back to reality, grabs the clothes from the chair, and heads toward the dressing room.

64 **INT. DRESSING ROOM - DAY** 64

Lucas is putting on his shirt while on the phone.

DAVID (V.O.)
We found Sophie. She said she wanted a smoke, but someone knocked her out and locked her in a car. Lucas, you need to watch out, it's the crazy fan again!

Emily knocks and pushes the door open, freezing the moment she steps in. Lucas hangs up, glancing at Emily with a mix of fear and seriousness.

LUCAS
Listen. From now on, you and Chloe stay home unless I’m with you. Don’t go anywhere without me, don’t leave my sight.

EMILY
(concerned)
Why? What happened?

LUCAS
Don’t worry about it. It’s for your own good.

EMILY
For my own good? Mark always says that, and then he went bankrupt without telling me, got promoted without telling me, and climbed into another woman's bed for "my own good."

LUCAS
Emily, trust me. I won't hurt you, I won't lie to you. Just do as I say for now, okay?

EMILY
I'm here to work for you, not to be your slave.

Disappointed, she tosses the clothes to Lucas and turns to leave. Lucas sighs. His phone rings again. Angry, he throws it aside. Then Emily's phone rings. It's Ryan.

RYAN (V.O.)
Been busy lately? I'd like to take you out for dinner.

Emily instinctively wants to refuse, but she glances back at the dressing room door firmly closed.

EMILY
(a bit stubborn)
Of course I have time. Send me the address.

EPISODE 30

65 **INT. OFFICE - DAY** 65

Emily walks holding a stack of documents, scrolling on her phone and muttering to herself.

EMILY
Lucas has an interview the day after tomorrow, first I need to put this contract-

Her mind flashes back to the argument with Lucas the day before.

EMILY (CONT'D)
Forget it, I'll deal with it at home.

She enters the break room, placing the files on the table and taking a sip of coffee. Anna pushes the door open, raising an eyebrow.

ANNA
I heard you shot the ad as a stand-in yesterday.

EMILY
None of your business.

Anna deliberately bumps into Emily, causing her coffee to spill on her shirt.

ANNA
(smirking)
Single moms should stay home and take care of her kid. Forty and still dreaming of stardom?

EMILY
(forced smile)
Yeah, yeah, you're right.

Emily forces a smile and leaves the break room. Lucas watches from a distance, taking out his phone.

LUCAS
David, I'll go on that reality show you mentioned last time, on one condition.

Anna sees Lucas and immediately steps forward. Lucas finishes his call and walks toward her.

ANNA
(flicking hair)
Looking for me? It's kinda crowded here, let's go to my car-

LUCAS
(smiling)
No need for that. I just wanted to tell you our company is terminating your project.

ANNA
What? You can’t do that! We have three albums left!

LUCAS
I can. I’m the Ace of this company, and I don’t want to see you here.

I won't just terminate your contract, I'll blacklist you across all platforms.

Anna steps back in disbelief. Lucas smirks and turns to leave.

ANNA
You… for Emily? You're actually going to destroy my career?

LUCAS
(pausing, turns back)
The newbie Emily manages won rookie awards in their second year. And you? You sing off-key and sleep with producers for roles. How dare you question her ability?

Lucas leaves with a cold smile. Anna glares at him.

66 **INT. EMILY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT** 66

Emily returns home, takes off her shoes, and walks to the dining table. Suddenly, she sees a drawing on the table, drawn by Chloe, showing two adults and a child holding hands. The man's name is labeled Lucas, Chloe is in the middle, and Emily is to the side.

QUCIK FLASHBACK STARTS

A heartwarming moment between Lucas and Chloe.

END FLASHBACK

Emily turns to pour water but gets distracted, spilling some.

EMILY (V.O.)
Perhaps Lucas really had his reasons before… But Chloe probably needs a steady and mature father figure like Ryan who can guide her more…

EPISODE 31

67 **INT. RESTAURANT - DAY** 67

Emily is having lunch with Ryan, glancing at a message from Lucas.

LUCAS(V.O.)
Are you free tonight? I need to review tomorrow's interview.

RYAN
(cutting steak)
Chloe's school has a father-daughter camping trip next week, right? She should be going with a father.

Emily sips water, her mind flashing to Lucas's face, causing her to choke slightly.

RYAN (CONT'D)
(handing a napkin)
You okay?

Emily shakes her head. Suddenly, her phone keeps vibrating. She quickly answers.

COLLEAGUE (V.O.)
Emily! Lucas blacklisted Anna!

EMILY
(frowning)
Why would Lucas do that?

RYAN
I need to tell you something.

But Emily is already dialing Lucas. He doesn't answer. She looks at Ryan apologetically.

EMILY
Sorry, let's talk later!

She rushes out of the restaurant. Ryan watches her back, sighing softly.

RYAN
For the father-daughter camping trip… I could be Chloe's dad too.

68 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 68

Emily rings the doorbell. Lucas opens, surprised to see her panting.

EMILY
Why did you blacklist Anna?

LUCAS
Sorry for my stupid words earlier…
but I can’t bear to see you suffer,
and I didn’t want you to hear those
terrible things.
(stepping closer)
I don't want to just be your
coworker, okay?

Emily impulsively kisses Lucas. He is stunned, staring at her, then hesitates and gently pushes her away.

EPISODE 32

69 **INT. LUCAS’ VILLA - DAY** 69

Emily impulsively kisses Lucas. He looks at her, surprised, and hesitates. Emily kisses him again. This time, Lucas gives in, sliding his arm around her waist to deepen the kiss. They stumble into the room, falling onto the bed, undressing and kissing passionately.

70 **INT. LUCAS’ VILLA - BEDROOM - DAY** 70

They lie on their sides, sweetly gazing at each other.

EMILY
It feels like I’m dreaming.

LUCAS
(thumb brushing her lips)
Me too.

EMILY
If you're just chasing a thrill, I
can leave right now.

LUCAS
(low laugh)
You think a thrill lasts eight
years?

EMILY
(stunned)
Eight years?

Emily sits up, turning slightly to slide out of Lucas’s embrace, unnoticed by him.

LUCAS
The first time I saw you was in the
rehearsal studio.

I was seventeen, mocked for my accent… you told me the audience will always remember the ones who really worked for it. I've remembered ever since, Emily.

EMILY
(hesitant)
It was you? You never told me.

LUCAS
I wanted to be worthy of you before telling you.

He takes her hand and places it on his chest.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
My heart is beating louder than being on stage. Believe me?

Emily nods. Lucas kisses her again.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Let's go. I'm giving you an unforgettable date.

He pulls her hand. Emily hesitates, then follows.

71 **EXT. STREET - DAY** 71

Walking on the streetAt a popular ice cream truck, Lucas wears a mask and baseball cap. Emily glances at him.

EMILY
Vanilla or salted caramel?

LUCAS
(glancing around)
Your choice. I'm not eating.

Emily looks puzzled. The vendor hands her the ice cream. They walk toward a small plaza. Emily licks her ice cream, deliberately offering some to Lucas.

EMILY
You gonna wear that where ever you go? You want some?

Lucas hesitates, scanning the area, then he removes his mask. Two fans nearby spot him and scream.

FANS
That's Lucas! Let's go see!

Lucas panics, grabbing Emily's wrist and running. They dive into an alley, the sounds of footsteps chasing behind them.

EPISODE 33

72 **EXT. STREET - DAY** 72

Lucas drags Emily to a cargo van, fumbling with the keys. His breathing is heavy, sweat beading on his temples.

EMILY
Did you run too fast? Take a moment to catch your breath-

LUCAS
(opening the van's rear door, urgent)
Get in. Now!

He pulls Emily inside and shuts the door.

73 **INT. VAN - DAY** 73

Outside, footsteps approach. Emily opens her mouth to speak, but Lucas quickly covers it.

OBSESSED FAN (O.S.)
I swear I saw Lucas… how did he disappear around the corner? Why is there a van here? Is he hiding inside?

A few thumps sound against the van.

OBSESSED FAN (O.S.) (CONT'D)
I saw him with a woman… once I find them, I'll destroy her. He belongs to me alone.

The footsteps fade. Lucas exhales and releases Emily.

EMILY
(frowning, holding his trembling hand)
Lucas, you scared me. What's going on?

Lucas looks up at her, throat moving as he steels himself.

LUCAS
(taking a deep breath)
For months now… every day she sends me strange messages. Then it's strange calls, strange emails…

EMILY
And then?

LUCAS
She started sending things to the villa, cards written in blood, photos of us, and… A broken doll with my concert wristband around its neck.

Emily gasps, voice trembling.

EMILY
Did you call the police?

LUCAS
Yes, but the messages were from virtual emails of different IPs. I recognized her voice just now.

Emily holds his face, forcing him to look at her.

EMILY
So that’s why you didn’t want Chloe going to your house… and why you insisted I stay in your sight?

Lucas nods, looking apologetic.

EMILY (CONT'D)
(soft but firm)
Silly Lucas, listen. I’m here. No matter how crazy she is, it’s just one person. She won’t win.

Lucas stares at her for a moment, then finally nods. He flips a switch inside the van. Warm lights illuminate a picnic blanket, an ice bucket, and champagne.

EMILY (CONT'D)
(disbelief)
You planned all this?

EPISODE 34

LUCAS
Your unforgettable date, as promised, Ma'am.

Lucas' hands are still shaking. Seeing him like this, Emily's eyes soften. She leans in, kissing him gently. Lucas returns the kiss with surprise and passion. They tumble onto the blanket, lost in a heated embrace.

75 **INT. VAN - DAY** 75

Emily sits up, pulling her clothes on. Lucas is shirtless, his hand tracing circles on her waist. Suddenly, her phone rings, it's Rebecca. Emily picks up.

EMILY
(face pale)
What happened? Chloe's running a fever? I'm coming!

LUCAS
(sitting up, serious)
Which hospital?

EMILY
(urgent)
It's crowded, don't come, you might get photographed.
(stops, kisses his lips to soothe him)
I'll message you when I arrive.

Emily opens the van door and rushes out. Lucas hesitates, then puts on his clothes, grabbing his hat and mask.

LUCAS
To heck with that crazy fan!

76 **INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - NIGHT** 76

Chloe lies in bed receiving an IV, frowning in discomfort.

EMILY
(holding her hand, whispering)
Sweetie, mommy's here.

Ryan sits nearby, looking up calmly.

RYAN
Rebecca had to leave, and you didn't arrive, so she called me. Don’t worry, Chloe’s fever’s already gone down.

EMILY
(tearing up)
Thank you, Ryan.

RYAN
(patting her shoulder)
You’re exhausted. It’s okay to rely on me.

At the door, Lucas, basseball cap pulled low, watches silently. His gaze lands on Emily and Ryan, Ryan’s hand patting Emily’s back as she dabs her tears.

LUCAS (V.O.)
They look… so right together. I can't even be beside her in public…

EPISODE 35

77 **INT. HOSPITAL - ROOM - DAY** 77

Emily leans against Ryan’s shoulder, dozing off. Ryan is about to brush her hair from her face when Mark suddenly bursts into the room.

MARK
(pointing at her nose)
What kind of mother are you? The kid hit 39°C and you didn’t notice?

Emily jolts awake, her face cold. She grabs Mark and drags him into the hallway, shutting the door behind them.

78 **INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - DAY** 78

EMILY
(coldly)
Don’t shout in the hospital. You're scaring Chloe.

MARK
You spend all day orbiting celebrities and don’t even notice your own daughter sick? You’re not fit to be a mother!

EMILY
(laughs angrily)
You cheated on me during our marriage and ignored Chloe. You have no right to say that!

Ryan comes out of the room, stepping between them.

RYAN
Sir, don't yell in the hallway.

MARK
(eyeing him, sneering)
Oh, and who's this hero here? Saving the damsel?
(looks at Emily)
Where's that Lucas guy?

RYAN
We should focus on the child first, not blaming each other.

MARK
(mocking)
Focus on the child? More like focusing on whoring.

EMILY
Mark, save it. Worry about the horns on your own head first.

MARK
(confused)
What do you mean?

EMILY
(shrugs, smiling)
Just go ask your "true love".

Emily drags Ryan back into the room. Frustrated, Markhe storms off, fumbling with his phone.

79 **EXT. HOSPITAL - DAY** 79

Mark is walking out when suddenly a bag is thrown over his head from behind. Lucas punches and kicks Mark.

MARK
(pained)
Who-

LUCAS
(with exaggerated accent)
Just a passerby. You just have such a punch-able face.

EPISODE 36

80 **EXT. HOSPITAL ENTRANCE - DAY** 80

Lucas leaves a stack of photos exposing Anna's affair behind, walking away confidently. Mark, bruised and battered, struggles out of the bag. His eyes fall on the photos, confusion quickly turning to rage.

81 **INT. HOSPITAL - ROOM - NIGHT** 81

The hallway is dim, only a small night lamp glows in the room. Emily gently pushes the door open, holding a takeout bag.

EMILY
I'm back-

Her voice catches in her throat. Inside, Lucas is leaning on the edge of the bed, Chloe resting her head on his arm. His eyes are closed, hand softly patting Chloe's shoulder to lull her to sleep. Emily stands still, watching the scene with tenderness. The door creaks lightly, and Lucas notices her presence.

LUCAS
(panicked)
I was just putting her to sleep and about to leave.

EMILY
(teasing)
You got what you wanted and now don't want to see me?

LUCAS
(faltering)
That's not what I mean… After your kiss today, I lost control. I shouldn't have confessed so impulsively… it put you both in danger.

EMILY
(softly)
We promised to face everything together, remember?

LUCAS
I will protect you both.

82 **INT. HOSPITAL - ROOM - DAY** 82

On Chloe's discharge day, Emily and Lucas stand in the hallway, listening to the doctor's advice. Ryan arrives, holding a teddy bear.

DOCTOR
Chloe is still weak. It's best if her parents spend more time with her and help her do some exercises.

RYAN / LUCAS
What kind of exercises?

Emily gives an apologetic glance at Ryan, then gently presses on Lucas, recording the instructions on her phone as she escorts the doctor out.

RYAN (CONT'D)
I'm not too busy this second half of the year. I can spend time with Chloe regularly.

Lucas smirks, pulls Emily closer, and kisses her. Ryan watches, stunned.

LUCAS
I can be a consistent presence in both of their lives!

At that moment, Chloe runs out from the room.

CHLOE
Mom, are you with Lucas now?

Ryan freezes at Chloe's question and looks at Emily. His expression hardens, and he silently turns to leave.

EPISODE 37

83 **INT. HOSPITAL - ROOM - DAY** 83

EMILY
(panicked, speechless)
Uh… well…

LUCAS
Yes, we're dating.

CHLOE
YES! Lucas is going to be my dad!

At that moment, Emily's phone rings. She answers.

EMILY
(shocked)
A Weber-Hopp Musical? They want Lucas?

She looks at a happy Chloe with Lucas, and goes out of the room to take the call.

84 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - NIGHT** 84

EMILY
Are you interested in the Weber-Hopp musical?

LUCAS
(lazy)
No time. I plan to rest and take you and Chloe traveling.

EMILY
(frowning)
But this is an amazing opportunity.

At that moment, the doorbell rings. David shouts from outside.

DAVID (O.S.)
Lucas?

EMILY
(whispering)
Boss?

Emily looks guilty and runs upstairs ducks under the table to hide. Lucas shakes his head helplessly and opens the door. David enters, holding scripts, and throws the documents onto the table.

DAVID
Do you know how crazy people went fighting for this script? And you disappeared with your phone off! Weber-Hopp specifically requested you. Why not sign?

LUCAS
(sipping coffee)
My daughter needs care. I plan to rest for a while.

DAVID
(surprised)
Daughter? Since when…

EPISODE 38

85 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - NIGHT** 85

DAVID
(surprised)
Daughter? Since when did you… I don’t care who you’re with, this is a once-in-a-lifetime chance! Miss this musical, and you'll never get another chance!

LUCAS
Then let it go. I don't need to rely on just one opportunity.

Lucas deliberately knocks his cup to the floor. Emily, curled under the table, hugs her knees. The cup rolls to her feet. Lucas bends down to pick it up, covers her with the tablecloth, and kisses her. Emily’s eyes widen. He stands up. David paces anxiously, Lucas lounges casually in the chair.

DAVID
You really think you have a steady career? The producers are already asking me for a backup male lead. One last chance, will you sign?

LUCAS
No.

DAVID
(shaking head, sighing)
Fine, you stubborn ass. I’ll prepare the PR myself.

Lucas pats him on the shoulder, smiling.

LUCAS
Thanks, take care on the way.

David leaves, the door closes. Lucas immediately lifts the tablecloth, carrying Emily walks out.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
That little moment wasn't enough, you still have interest to pay me.

EMILY
(pushes him seriously)
Chloe doesn’t need you fussing over her. You should’ve listened to David and signed the contract!

LUCAS
(kissing her palm)
Kids grow up fast. If I don’t spend time with her now, what if she doesn't want me as a dad later?

Lucas mentioning Chloe makes Emily hesitate for a second, then regain resolve.

EMILY
Chloe is my daughter. I’ll take care of her. You should…

LUCAS
Enough. I’ll be honest. I actually don’t like this script.

LUCAS (V.O.)
Perhaps stepping back from the spotlight and obsessive fans is the only way to keep you safe.

EPISODE 39

86 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - NIGHT** 86

Lucas glances at his phone and ditches the call.

LUCAS
Annoying guy.

Ryan calls again. Emily answers.

EMILY
Hey, Ryan.

Lucas pulls her into his lap, grinning wickedly, and kisses the side of her neck.

RYAN (V.O.)
Can we meet one last time?

LUCAS
Do you want to see him, or continue with me?

Lucas snatches the phone, flips it face-down on the table, and the two of them kiss fervently.

87 **EXT. VILLA - POOL — DAY** 87

Lucas walks along the pool, reading a text on his phone:

OBSESSED FAN
Lukiepoo, where did you go? I haven't seen you for three days. Is that old hag hiding you?

He takes a breath and deletes the message. Under a sun umbrella, his friends lounge on deck chairs.

LUCAS
(walking over, sits)
Hey guys!

At that moment Emily appears in a bikini, draped in a big towel.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
(waves them over)
Here!

Emily sits beside Lucas, his arm naturally goes around her shoulders.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Everyone, this is my girlfriend, Emily Carter.

GUY A
Girlfriend? Are you sure she isn’t your…Aunt?

GUY B
(quiet)
He once said he’d loved someone for eight years...is that her?

Guys’ face changes.

Lucas nods, then Guy A pulls him aside.

GUY A
Bro, are you serious? You always joked about liking someone ten years older than you. It's real?

LUCAS
(rolls his eyes)
After all these years, you still don’t get it? I’m serious.

GUY A
Are you out of your mind? I thought our friend Maya is much mo-

LUCAS
(cold, cutting him off)
What? Since when did I need your approval? I want the person I truly love, and that’s Emily. If you can’t respect my girlfriend, then we’re not friends anymore.
(take Emily's hand)
Let’s go.

89 **INT. CAR — DAY** 89

Emily stares out the window, arms crossed. Lucas steers with one hand while covering her hand with the other.

LUCAS
What are you Still thinking?

EMILY
What they said...isn’t entirely wrong. I have a child and maybe our identity and age difference really is…

Lucas cuts her off, serious.

EPISODE 41

90 **INT. CAR — DAY** 90

LUCAS
Stop. Age? I was born while you were in school, how cool is that? Chloe?

I'm glad to be the cool dad that stepped up. It's all wins to me.

EMILY
(half-smile)
Won’t you regret it someday?

Lucas signals, pulls over, sets the parking brake, and faces her.

LUCAS
Listen, what I’d regret is not pursuing you sooner. Want me to swear on something?

EMILY
(presses her finger to his lips)
I believe you.

Lucas grins. Emily kisses him. Outside, the obsessed fan snaps photos with a telephoto lens.

OBSESSED FAN
(smiling)
Finally found you, darling.

91 **INT. ANNA’S COMPANY DRESSING ROOM — DAY** 91

Anna scrolls through high-res photos the stalker sent of Lucas and Emily kissing in a car. She zooms in on Emily’s profile and sneers. She texts back while muttering.

ANNA
Send me the original. The money is on the way.

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
Lucas, you forced me to do this. You should be kept at my home, for my eyes only.

Anna frowns. She replies.

ANNA
What do you mean?

No response. She pockets the phone.

ANNA (CONT'D)
Got you at last.

She sets the phone down, stares at her reflection, face hardening.

ANNA (CONT'D)
Lucas, I can't believe you made the entire industry blacklist me! I'll make you pay.

EPISODE 42

92 **INT. MARK'S OFFICE - DAY** 92

Anna storms in, tossing her phone onto the desk.

ANNA
Lucas is in a secret relationship! If we leak this, his fans will turn on him!

Mark smirks, slamming down the photos he has of Anna, the intimate hotel shots with a film investor.

MARK
Care to explain this?

ANNA
(stunned)
I- It's just showbiz…

MARK
You dare lie to me? You slut!

He slaps Anna across the face. Anna reels in disbelief, covering her face.

ANNA
Without me, you wouldn't even be in this position!

MARK
You're just a blacklisted loser now. We're done!

Mark storms out. Anna picks up her phone to send Lucas and Emily's kissing photos to the media.

ANNA
(gritting her teeth)
Lucas, Emily… you did this. I'll ruin you both!

She calls someone, her face twisted in maliciousness.

93 **INT. EMILY'S APARTMENT - EMILY'S ROOM - DAY** 93

The phone buzzes incessantly. Emily groggily reaches out from under the covers and answers.

REBECCA (V.O.)
(screaming)
Babe! Check the trending news! You and Lucas were exposed! It's the photos of you kissing Lucas!

Emily snaps awake, sits up, and scrolls frantically through the screen.

EMILY
This is bad…

Her fingers tremble as she opens the comments:

Fan A: Impossible! Lucas doesn't have that bad of taste!

Fan B: She's old enough to be his mom! Old hag, let Lucas go!

Fan C: Outsiders think it's cute, but to us true fans, the world's ending.

Emily jumps out of bed, hurriedly getting dressed and rushing out.

EPISODE 43

94 **EXT. COMPANY ENTRANCE - DAY** 94

REPORTERS and **FANS** crowd the entrance.

REPORTER A
Is Lucas really in a relationship? I heard his girlfriend is his manager, any conflicts of interest there?

FAN A
The witch old hag must go!

FAN B
(crying)
Lucas, come out and explain! We're waiting for you to debunk the rumors!

EMPLOYEE
(blocking the entrance)
It’s a misunderstanding, everyone calm down! The official statement is coming soon!

REPORTER B
“Coming soon”? Ten minutes or ten hours? We can wait, can the fans?

FAN A
I want an answer now! Not one second more!

Emily steps out of the car and frowns at the scene. A security guard approaches and escorts her to a side door.

SECURITY GUARD
This way. Mr. Lucas' instructions.

EMILY
Thanks.

95 **INT. DAVID’S OFFICE - DAY** 95

The computer screen shows the trending news title: Superstar Lucas does Hot Make Out Session in Car.

DAVID
Explain this! I’m not against you dating, but hide it better! Now how do I explain this to the brands?

Lucas lounges on the edge of the desk, hands in pockets, tone casual.

LUCAS
Perfect. Saves us paying paparazzi to sneak photos. Make it public, it saves money.

DAVID
(stands abruptly)
Public? Are you willing to ruin your career for a woman?

LUCAS
(smiling fades)
Compared to my career, I care about Emily more.

96 **MONTAGE STARTS** 96

Emily walks into the office, her colleagues' eyes follow her, whispering. She ignores them.

In the break room, co-workers stare. Her hands tremble slightly as she pours water.

As she exits the company, reporters surround her. Flashes go off. Emily staggers, disoriented, almost falling. Lucas appears, heroically shielding her. The crowd gasps in awe.

98 **MONTAGE ENDS** 98

EPISODE 44

99 **EXT. COMPANY ENTRANCE - DAY** 99

Emily walks out from the building,C crowds push and shove. Emily misses a step, about to fall, but a hand steadies her waist.

REPORTER B
(excited)
It's Lucas! Please respond to the fans!

Lucas removes his hat, facing the cameras, holding Emily's hand tightly.

LUCAS
Yes, I'm in a relationship. I love my girlfriend with all my hearty.

Everyone is stunned.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
I've said my piece. I won't respond to anything else. Anyone who harasses my girlfriend again will hear from my lawyers!

Lucas glances at Emily, his tone softening.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Come on, let's go home.

Emily's eyes glisten with tears as she nods.

EMILY
Okay.

He guides her down the steps. The reporters automatically give way. David, standing not far off, watches, face dark as iron, muttering under his breath.

DAVID
Madness… all of them are mad!

100 **INT. LUCAS VILLA - CAR - DAY** 100

Emily leans back in the seat, still holding Lucas's hand.

EMILY
You were too impulsive. Your endorsements, ads, fans… everything could take a hit.

LUCAS
(gripping the wheel, eyes forward)
So be it. As long as my singing isn't affected, it's fine.

EMILY
What if work stops coming to you?

LUCAS
(smirking)
Then I'll sing on the streets.

EMILY
(shaking his arm)
Stop joking, I mean it.

LUCAS
(sober)
I'm serious. Even if I give up my career, it doesn't matter. All I want is you.

Emily is moved.

101 **INT. EMILY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT** 101

The door opens. Chloe runs in, hugging Emily's waist.

CHLOE
(looking up, eyes sparkling)
I saw the news! You two were kissing!

Emily crouches to fix her hair.

EMILY
Sorry, did that make your classmates ask too many questions?

CHLOE
(shouting)
I don’t care! Superstar Lucas is my dad now! So cool!

Lucas, smiling, opens the fridge, searching for ingredients.

LUCAS
I’ll cook tonight. Is pasta okay?

CHLOE
Double cheese!

LUCAS
Double it is! Today, we celebrate!

Chloe dances excitedly. Emily watches the warm scene in front of her, smiling unconsciously.

EPISODE 45

102 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 102

The doorbell rings frantically. Half-asleep, Lucas opens the door. Flyers are scattered all over the ground:“YOU DON'T DESERVE TO BE A STAR!”“GIVE US OUR LUCAS BACK!”“OLD HAG, GO AWAY!” He frowns, bending to pick one up. Suddenly, two young women rush at him, phones thrust right into his face, recording.

CRAZY FAN A
Lucas! Explain yourself!

LUCAS
(blocking the camera)
You’re trespassing my private property.

CRAZY FAN B
(teary)
You’re dating someone! What about your fans? You betrayed us!

LUCAS
Who I love is my choice. Please leave.

Security rushes in, pushing the girls back. Lucas shuts the door. The house goes silent. His phone rings on the table.

He picks it up and puts it on speaker.

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
(screaming)
Lucas! Why did you give up your career for her? What's so good about that old woman?!

Lucas glances across the room. Two **POLICE OFFICERS** on the sofa nod to him. His tone suddenly softens.

LUCAS
I know I was wrong. It's all my fault. Baby, can you forgive me?

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
(hesitant)
Really?

LUCAS
Where are you right now?

OBSESSED FAN (V.O.)
(delighted)
I've been by your side all along!

EPISODE 46

103 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 103

Lucas sits elegantly on the couch, his phone rings.looks again at the police officers. They nod. Shortly after, one officer answers a call from a colleague.

POLICE OFFICER A
(on phone)
Mr. Lucas, we caught them.

LUCAS
(relieved)
Thank you.

Lucas's phone is still buzzing relentlessly. The notifications show 99+ messages: "Unfollowed!" "Give us our time back!" "KYS!"

POLICE OFFICER
(concerned)
Do you need any more help?

Lucas swipes the screen; his finger lingers over Emily's name.

No, thanks.

104 **INT. DAVID’S OFFICE - DAY** 104

David slides a file bag across the desk to Emily. The edge of the bag reveals the words: “Contract Termination Notice.”

DAVID
Let’s be straightforward. Break up with Lucas. It’s better for everyone.

EMILY
I promised Lucas we won’t give up on each other.

DAVID
Then we'll terminate the contract.

David turns the tablet toward Emily. The screen shows a summary of the penalties.

DAVID (CONT'D)
(continuing)
Look carefully. It's eight figures, in dollars.

Emily freezes.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Brands are lining up to terminate his contracts. The penalties will drain him. Do you really want to watch him fall?

Emily recalls Lucas staying up late writing songs, eyes welling with tears.

EMILY
No… he worked so hard to come this far.

DAVID
Good that you understand. If you leave, he’ll still be the shining golden idol Lucas.
(pauses, softening)
If you love him… would you let him go bankrupt for you?

Emily is silent for a few seconds.

EMILY
I… need to think.

DAVID
Don't ponder too long. The brands are giving us seventy-two hours. I'll wait for your call.

Emily turns and leaves.

105 **INT. HOTEL - DAY** 105

The doorbell rings. Lucas smiles as he steps forward to open the door.

LUCAS
Emily-

Before he can finish, a knife stabs towards his abdomen.

EPISODE 47

106 **INT. HOTEL - DAY** 106

Before Lucas can finish his sentence, a knife stabs towards his abdomen. Lucas sidesteps, and the blade rips through his shirt. He grabs the attacker's wrist and shoves her backward. The obsessed fan, wearing a mask, staggers, eyes crazed.

OBSESSED FAN
Lucas, you can only belong to me!

LUCAS
(stunned)
It's you?

OBSESSED FAN
The "arrest" was just a trick! I'll make you understand, only I love you the most in this world!

107 **INT. HOTEL - HALLWAY - DAY** 107

Emily notices the commotion ahead and freezes before rushing forward.

EMILY
(shouting)
Lucas?

The obsessed fan frowns, eyes venomous.

OBSESSED FAN
It’s you? You stole my Lucas. Now Lucas can be with me forever!

She lunges at Emily with the knife. Lucas, shocked, instantly steps forward to block, his arm catching the blade. Blood instantly soaks his sleeve. He grunts, reverses his grip to seize the attacker’s wrist and slams them against the wall.

LUCAS
Enough!

OBSESSED FAN
(struggling)
Let go! I want her gone!

EMILY
(shouting)
Help! Someone’s got a knife here!

Two security guards rush over and restrain her. Emily immediately rushes to Lucas, hands trembling as she presses his wound.

EMILY (CONT'D)
You’re bleeding so much…

EPISODE 48

108 **INT. HOTEL HALLWAY - DAY** 108

Emily immediately rushes to Lucas, hands trembling as she presses his wound.

EMILY
You’re bleeding so much…

LUCAS
(smiling, pale)
I'm okay. Don't cry.

EMILY
Hospital! Now!

She supports Lucas as they leave.

109 **INT. HOSPITAL - DAY** 109

Lucas sits on a chair, having his wound bandaged. Emily glances down at her phone, then steps aside to answer a call.

TEACHER (V.O.)
Ms. Carter? Recent public attention is affecting the school. Chloe will take a leave until the dust settles.

EMILY
(stunned)
Temporary leave? For how long?

SCHOOL
One to two months. Can you pick her up today?

EMILY
Alright, I'll go immediately.

110 **EXT. SCHOOL GATE - DAY** 110

Emily pulls her car to the side, spotting Chloe standing alone at the gate, backpack on, eyes red. She rushes out.

EMILY
Chloe? Why are you standing outside?

CHLOE
(sniffling)
Nobody wants to play with me… and the teacher told me to go home. Mom, I wanna go home…

EMILY
(gripping her hand)
Okay, let's go home.

Emily holds Chloe's hand as they get into the car. She sends a quick message to David:

EMILY(V.O.)
I've made my decision.

111 **INT. EMILY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT** 111

Emily is on the phone with David.

EMILY
If I leave Lucas, will the brand stop the contract cancellations?

DAVID (V.O.)
Of course. He'll still be the top star. Emily, your presence is the source of his trouble.

EMILY
(her gaze darkens)
I understand.

Sitting on the sofa, Emily stares at Lucas's chat window on her phone. She types, deletes, types again, then finally locks the screen. She walks to her wardrobe, pulling out a sleek, tight-fitting dress.

EPISODE 49

112 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - NIGHT** 112

The doorbell rings. Lucas, just out of the shower, towel around his head, opens the door and freezes at the sight of Emily in the sexy dress.

EMILY
(seductively smiling)
Do I look good?

LUCAS
(laughing, pulling her inside)
Absolutely stunning.

Lucas can't shift his eye off of her. Emily walks up and kisses him. Lucas closes his eyes, returning the kiss. Emily tears up. They tumble together, shedding clothes piece by piece, breaths heavy and urgent.

113 **INT. LUCAS' VILLA - DAY** 113

Lucas rolls over, groggily reaching out, only to feel cold emptiness beside him. He opens his eyes and sits up, noticing a note on the bedside table: "Lucas, forget me. Take the invitation for *Miracle.* I believe you can do it. — Emily" Lucas snatches his phone and dials, but it's off. Barefoot, he searches the apartment, checking every room.

LUCAS
Emily? Don't play around, this isn't funny.

114 **INT. CAR - DAY** 114

Emily grips the steering wheel, eyes red from tears. Chloe sits in the back, holding her small backpack, looking sad.Emily pets Chloe's head silently, eyes full of tears.

CHLOE
Mom, are we really not going to tell Lucas? Will he cry if he can’t find us?

EMILY
No. So we won’t cry either, okay?

Chloe nods, secretly wiping away a tear.

115 **EXT. SCHOOL GATE - DAY** 115

The school gate is open. Lucas jumps out of his car and rushes to the guard.

LUCAS
Did Chloe Carter come today?

GUARD
Chloe Carter? Her transfer was just processed last night.

116 **INT. AIRPORT RESTAURANTS - DAY** 116

Emily pushes the luggage cart, Chloe holding her hand. Lucas jumps out of a taxi, running into the entrance. He scans the crowd, dialing his phone, but it’s still off.

LUCAS
(under his breath)
Damn it…

He searches frantically, brushing past Emily.

BOARDING ANNOUNCEMENT
Flight to S City is now boarding.

Emily glances back once, then leads Chloe leave.

EPISODE 50

117 **INT. LUCAS’ VILLA - DAY** 117

Curtains are tightly drawn. Takeout boxes are piled high, clothes are scattered across the carpet.

Lucas slouches on the sofa, unshaven. A soap opera is playing 84.
on the TV, the remote on the floor. David bursts in, pinching
his nose.

DAVID
It stinks! Are you planning to rot
here until you die?

LUCAS
(eyes vacant)
She’s gone… does it even matter?

DAVID
(kicking aside trash,
standing before him)
You think she'd be happy seeing you
like this?

LUCAS
(looking up, hollow)
She left… what else can I do? What
do you want from me?

Lucas suddenly covers his face and sobs. David grabs his
shoulders, shaking him firmly as he shouts.

DAVID
Live like a man! Let her see you in
the news, not the garbage pile!

LUCAS
(clearing his mind)
Right… I’ll make sure she sees me.

He jumps up, kicking a beer can across the room.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Call a press conference.

118 **INT. PRESS CONFERENCE - DAY** 118

Lucas stands on stage in a black suit.

LUCAS
Today I'm announcing two things.
First, I will star as the male lead
in Weber-Hopp's musical *Miracle*.
Second, I will donate all profits
from my albums to charity.

He raises a hand to signal no further questions.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
I'll let my work speak for itself. Time will prove everything.

119 **INT. COMPANY CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY** 119

A large screen shows surveillance footage of Anna and Mark embezzling company funds.

HR
The evidence is conclusive. Both are immediately terminated and will bear all contractual and criminal liabilities.

ANNA
This must be fabricated!

MARK
I won't accept it!

Security drags them out.

EPISODE 51

120 **INT. AWARDS CEREMONY - NIGHT** 120

The host stands on stage, microphone in hand.

HOST
The Annual Best Album goes to *Lost* by Lucas! Congratulations!

Applause erupts. Lucas walks steadily on stage, receiving the trophy and microphone, scanning the audience.

LUCAS
I want to thank my staff and everyone who believed in me. The next song is for someone. Without her, there would be no Lucas today.

He suddenly freezes, eyes widening. Emily sits in the audience, smiling through tears, their eyes locking.

121 **INT. AWARDS CEREMONY - NIGHT** 121

Lucas's eyes glisten with tears. His assistant brings his guitar on stage and takes away the trophy. Lucas sits on a high stool, holding the guitar with one hand.

LUCAS
These past months, I've turned my insomnia into melodies, my longing into lyrics. If this song has a name, it's *Love*.

He hums and sings. By the song's end, tears sparkle in his eyes, but a small smile graces his lips.

LUCAS (CONT'D)
Thank you all who have been with me. From today, I will step away from the spotlight to pursue my artistic dreams. See you on stage again, I will never stop composing.

HOST
Lucas, are you announcing your retirement from showbiz?

LUCAS
Yes, there are more important things in life.

The audience erupts in shocked murmurs.

122 **INT. BACKSTAGE - NIGHT** 122

Lucas enters, scanning for Emily. Emily runs up and hugs him tightly around the waist.

EMILY
I'm here.

LUCAS
(embracing her, kisses the top of her head)
Don't ever leave me again, okay?

EPISODE 52

123 **INT. BACKSTAGE - NIGHT** 123

Emily nods firmly. They share a deep, passionate kiss as backstage lights glow around them.

124 **INT. TALENT AGENCY - DAY** 124

One year later. The glass doors read *Independent Talent Agency*. Emily, in a suit, taps her Bluetooth earpiece.

EMILY
Confirm the order for the Best Newcomer award red carpet again. Group A goes first.

125 **INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY** 125

Emily sits on the sofa, the room filled with trophies and stacks of documents on the table.

LUCAS
Honey, I’m hungry.

EMILY
There’s pizza in the fridge. Microwave for three minutes.

LUCAS
(holding her waist)
Pizza isn’t as good as you.

EMILY
(laughing, squirms)
Stop teasing, I’m busy.

LUCAS
(bites her ear playfully)
You’ve been neglecting me since we got married.

EMILY
(kisses him)
Is this enough?

Chloe bursts out of the room, shouting.

CHLOE
Mom, Dad, kissing secretly again!

EMILY
Not secretly! Openly and proudly.

CHLOE
I want some too!

She dives into their arms. The three of them laugh.